CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · NCERT-TYPE CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 11: **Helen Keller (poem) - Langston Hughes** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. NCERT-type: questions in the style of the textbook examples and exercises.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. Langston Hughes, the poet, is described in the book as: 1

(a) an Indian freedom fighter
(b) an American writer and activist known for jazz poetry
(c) a French painter
(d) a British novelist of fairy tales

2. What does the world receive from Keller's 'dower'? 1

(a) the message of the strength of inner power
(b) a gift of gold
(c) a new language
(d) a map of the world

3. The word 'receives' in 'the world receives' suggests the world is: 1

(a) fighting her **(b)** ignoring her
(c) robbing her **(d)** benefiting from her message

4. Hughes was a leader of the Harlem Renaissance, which means he helped in the revival of: 1

(a) Indian classical music only
(b) African-American literature, art, music and dance
(c) medieval architecture
(d) Greek drama

5. Why do the first two stanzas begin with just one word, 'She'? 1

(a) to put the focus fully on Keller **(b)** to rhyme with 'see'
(c) because the poet forgot the verb **(d)** to introduce a second person

6. Which of these best states the theme of the poem? 1

(a) beauty depends on clothes **(b)** fame is the goal of life
(c) true strength lies within the spirit **(d)** sight is the only way to see

7. According to 'Before You Read', Helen Keller became deaf and blind: 1

(a) at the age of fifty **(b)** in old age
(c) in her infancy **(d)** during college

8. The poem has how many stanzas? 1

(a) two **(b)** seven **(c)** five **(d)** three

9. The unit's digital/SDG link printed on the page is about: 1

(a) space travel **(b)** reduced inequalities
(c) clean energy **(d)** zero hunger

10. The poem is described as a tribute to Keller's: 1

(a) travels abroad **(b)** wealth and fame
(c) inner strength and determination **(d)** skill in painting

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Who wrote the poem 'Helen Keller'? Mention one fact about him. 2

12. What does the poet mean by 'the soul's own mastery'? 2

13. Why is the poem called a tribute? 2

14. What do we learn about Helen Keller from 'Before You Read'? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. What did Keller discover in the 'light' according to the poem, and does our eyesight decide whether we see such light? 3

16. Why is the poet's use of one word, 'She', at the start of two stanzas effective? 3

17. How does the last stanza differ from the first two? 3

OR

Explain 'Within herself, / Found loveliness'. Should one value inner beauty over outer beauty? 3

18. How does the short form of the poem reflect its theme of strength? 3

OR

What role does the margin note on 'dower' play for the reader? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain the poem 'Helen Keller' in your own words, stanza by stanza. 5

OR

Does this poem only apply to the disabled? Write a paragraph. 5

20. What does the poem teach us about inner strength and about how we treat people with disabilities? 5

OR

Write a short poem (3 stanzas, short lines, like the model) on a person you admire. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

INSTRUMIND